

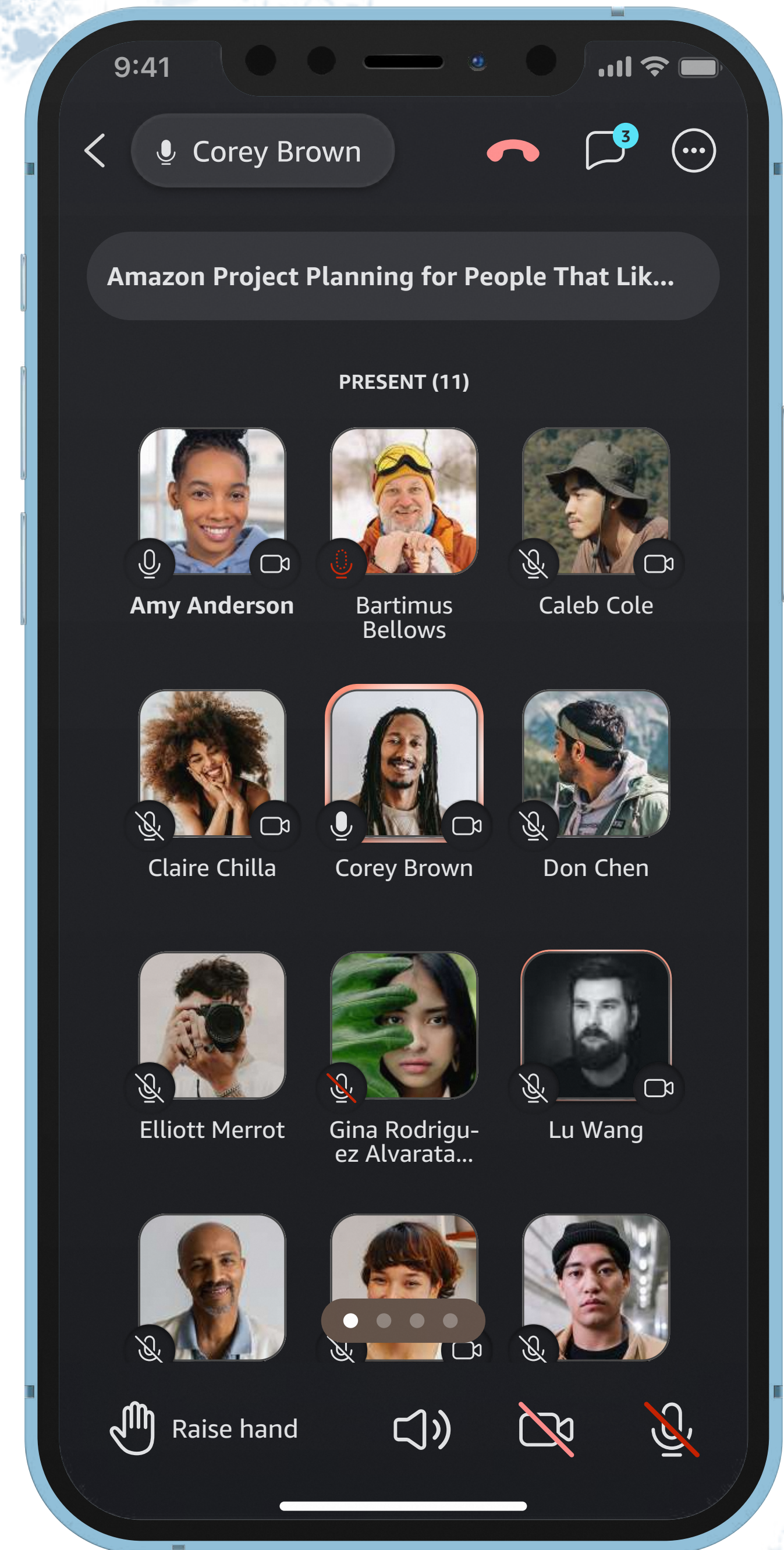


# Amazon Chime

5.0 release design

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Senior Product Designer



THE CHEATSHEET

Org Goal



Win “hearts & minds” of Amazonian users—  
The GM of Productivity Apps tasked us with this goal. The product was essentially unchanged since 2016 acquisition, and COVID-19 conferencing demands prompted a massive UI, UX, and back-end overhaul.

My role

Direct large-scale product update of iOS & Android, fast-following desktop’s work.

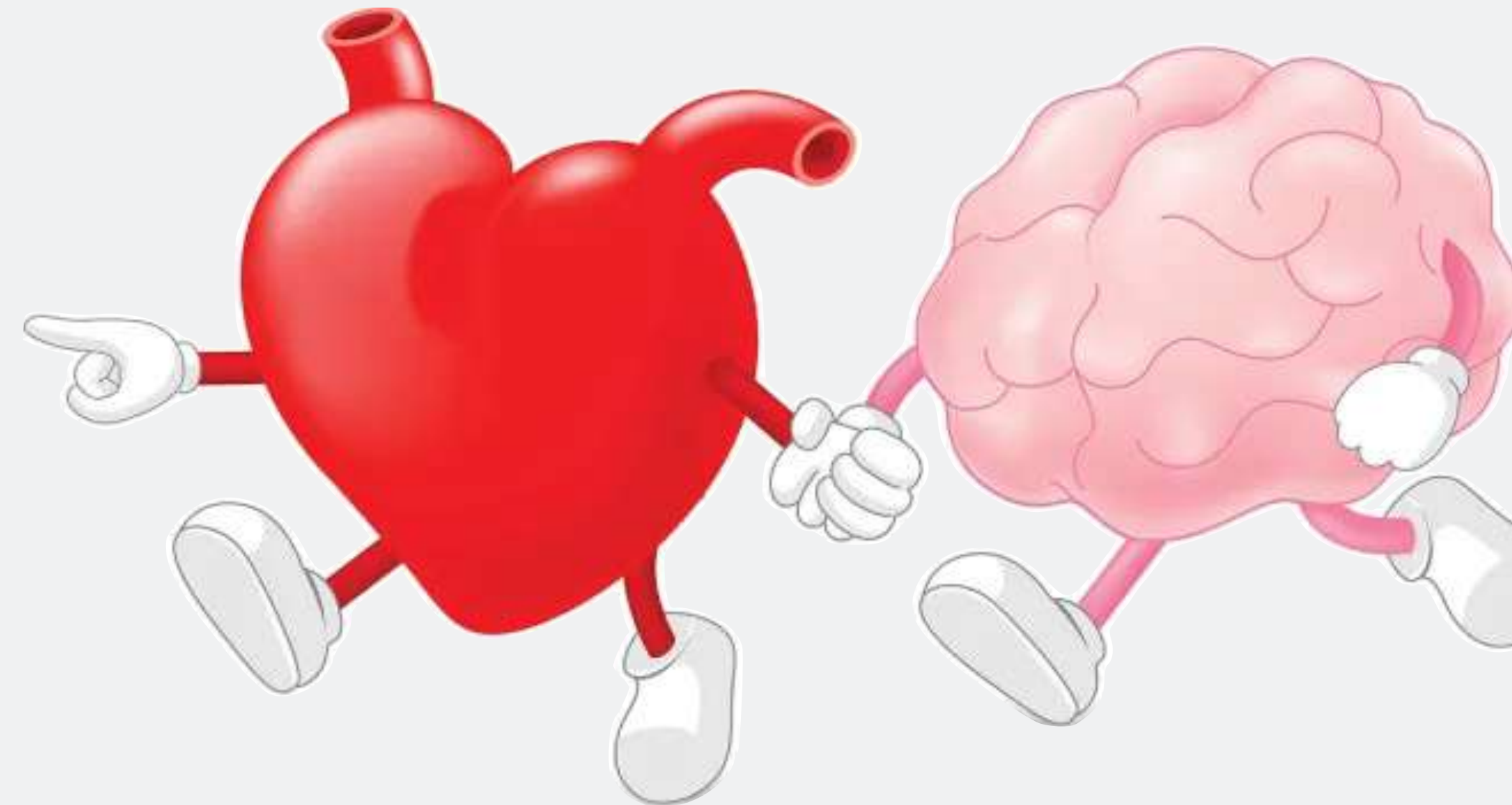
Designed for...

Knowledge workers that thrive on schedule flexibility without losing availability.



## Opening Challenges

- ♦ **Amazon Chime was not beloved**  
Hence the goal. The strategy was to create a better product by winning over internal users, but we had to overcome broken trust.
- ♦ **No research, ambiguous success metrics**  
“Win the hearts & minds of Amazonians” didn’t come with clear data or goals. We needed to find ways to quantify and justify decisions.
- ♦ **Platform-silo’d teams, no dedicated PM**  
Mobile’s kick-off was just me and an engineering manager, then hiring up his team of 5 iOS & 5 Android engineers.
- ♦ **We all wore many hats to compensate**  
I filled in gaps for mobile’s leadership, acting as interim PM, project manager, and ultimately running the beta testing program.





BACK TO BASICS

Charting mobile’s voyage

Desktop’s engineering team was ahead of mobile and frustrated by the grind. As interim PM, I interviewed their leads to see what our scrappy mobile team needed for success:

- ✦ Define scope & impact
- ✦ Lead with user research
- ✦ Map a clear forward path
- ✦ Communicate intentionally & often
- ✦ Document thoroughly

DISCOVER — EXPLORE — ITERATE — BUILD

2

UX Deliverables Index for NME mobile (archived)

H1

Master Doc: Chime Meetings NME 5.0 - Reference Links

Chime Meetings - 5.x NME Product Discussions (archived)

Prototypes and UI

Listed below, most current one on top.

|    | A          | B                                  | C                                                                                                                   | D          | E                                                                                                                   |
|----|------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  |            | Phase                              | Link                                                                                                                |            |                                                                                                                     |
| 2  | May 2022   | UX Specs                           | <a href="https://zpl.io/mDXBmm9">https://zpl.io/mDXBmm9</a>                                                         | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 3  | Jan 2022   | UI - Join Flow                     | <a href="https://zpl.io/amJwyyv">https://zpl.io/amJwyyv</a>                                                         | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 4  | May 2022   | UI - Mobile Meeting                | <a href="https://zpl.io/aXj6jrj">https://zpl.io/aXj6jrj</a>                                                         | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 5  | Aug 2021   | UI - Avatars                       | <a href="https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm">https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm</a> | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 6  | Aug 2021   | UI - Mira Design System            | <a href="https://zpl.io/bP7KnwD">https://zpl.io/bP7KnwD</a>                                                         | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 7  | April 2022 | Dark Mode- rest of app             | <a href="#">[Req] Mobile 5.x reskin   Current CX screenshots</a>                                                    | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 8  | Feb 2022   | Dark Mode - Meeting CX             | <a href="https://zpl.io/qyZOZnN">https://zpl.io/qyZOZnN</a>                                                         | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 9  |            |                                    |                                                                                                                     |            |                                                                                                                     |
| 10 | May 2022   | App store screens                  | <a href="https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm">https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm</a> | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 11 | June 2022  | Enlarge screenshare                | <a href="#">[Proposed UX] Screenshare to full [r2]</a>                                                              | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 12 | April 2022 | Accessibility docs                 | <a href="#">Accessibility</a>                                                                                       | Done       | <a href="https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm">https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm</a> |
| 13 | New        | <del>Dogfood Mobile 5.0 Beta</del> | <del>Beta Sign Up Wiki</del>                                                                                        | Done/State | <del><a href="#">Mobile 5.0 Dogfood</a></del>                                                                       |
| 14 | Jan 2022   | NME UI Audit                       | <a href="#">UI Audit</a>                                                                                            | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 15 | --         | UX - Audio cues                    | <a href="#">In-App Audio Cues</a>                                                                                   | Unfinished |                                                                                                                     |
| 16 | Aug 2021   | UX - Meeting alerts                | <a href="#">In-Meeting Event Messaging</a>                                                                          | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 17 | Aug 2021   | Chime Analytics Req                | <a href="#">Analytics to implement - Top things we want to learn</a>                                                | Done       | <a href="#">UX Metrics Wishlist</a>                                                                                 |
| 18 |            |                                    |                                                                                                                     |            |                                                                                                                     |
| 19 | June 2021  | Prototype Walkthrough video        | <a href="https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm">https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm</a> | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 20 | June 2021  | Iteration Prototype                | <a href="https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/K210WEAFSFU">https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/K210WEAFSFU</a>     | Done       | Password: beluga                                                                                                    |
| 21 | Aug 2021   | Iteration Active Speaker           | <a href="https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm">https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm</a> | Done       | Test gifs from VX a                                                                                                 |
| 22 | June 2021  | 6/18 Prototype Assets              | <a href="https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm">https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm</a> | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 23 |            |                                    |                                                                                                                     |            |                                                                                                                     |
| 24 | May 2021   | Chimehouse Ideation                | <a href="https://www.figma.com/proto/oIhn6YlwMi9pURbkAw">https://www.figma.com/proto/oIhn6YlwMi9pURbkAw</a>         | Done       |                                                                                                                     |
| 25 | Apr 2021   | Meeting Controls Usability         | <a href="https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/AN111UETVTB">https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/AN111UETVTB</a>     | Done       | Password: chime                                                                                                     |
| 26 | Apr 2021   | Exploration Prototype              | <a href="https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/XB111UEJGRCI">https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/XB111UEJGRCI</a>   | Done       | Password: beluga                                                                                                    |
| 27 |            |                                    |                                                                                                                     |            |                                                                                                                     |

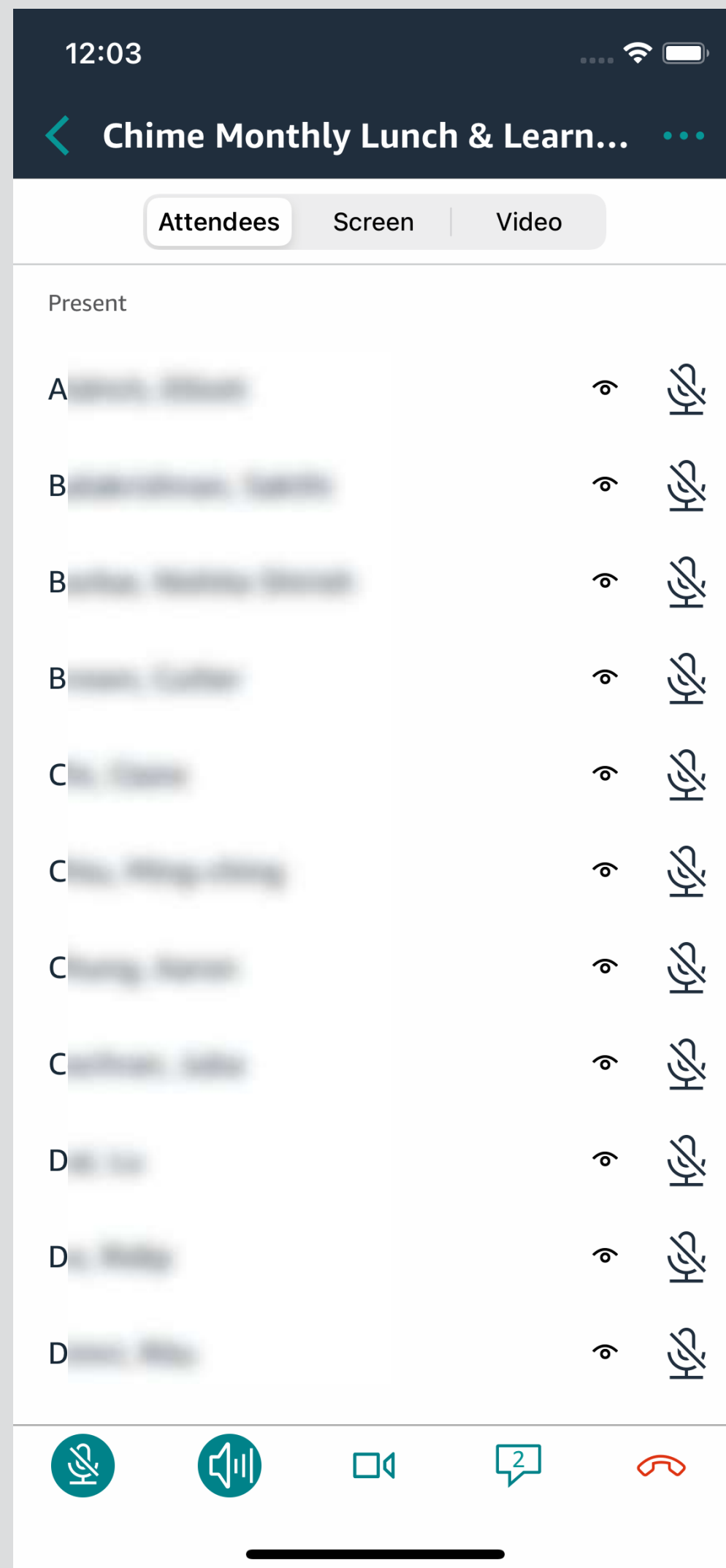
Completed Research

| A         | B                          | C                                                      | D                                                                                                                   | E                                                                                                                          | F    |
|-----------|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
|           | Research                   | Summary                                                | Link                                                                                                                | Raw notes/data                                                                                                             |      |
| Jan 2022  | 5.X Bravehearts Survey     | Survey beta testers about their mee                    | <a href="#">2022 February - Beta Feedback S</a>                                                                     | <a href="https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm">https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm</a>        | Done |
| Nov 2021  | Join Flow Usability        | A/B Usability for 2 variations                         | <a href="#">2021 November   Join Flow Red</a>                                                                       | <a href="https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm">https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm</a>        | Done |
| Sept 2021 | Beta Usability r1          | In-complete first pass usability                       | <a href="https://issues.amazon.com/Chime">https://issues.amazon.com/Chime</a>                                       | Reactions: <a href="https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/AN111UETVTB">https://amazon.invisionapp.com/share/AN111UETVTB</a> | Done |
| May 2021  | Mobile Meeting Analytics   | Quant data for mobile meetings                         | <a href="#">2021 May - Mobile Meetings Dat</a>                                                                      | <a href="https://issues.amazon.com/Chime">https://issues.amazon.com/Chime</a>                                              | Done |
| Apr 2021  | Meeting Controls Usability | A/B Usability for 2 variations                         | <a href="#">2021 April - Usability Findings</a>                                                                     | <a href="#">2021 April - Meet</a>                                                                                          | Done |
| Mar 2021  | User Interviews            | In-depth interviews for Chime meetings on mobile usage | <a href="#">2021 Mar User Interview Finding</a>                                                                     | <a href="#">2021 Mar - Mobil</a>                                                                                           | Done |
| Dec 2020  | Chime Mobile Survey        | Survey sent to bravehearts and interest                | <a href="https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm">https://amazon.awsapps.com/workdocs-beta/index.htm</a> |                                                                                                                            | Done |



# HIGH IMPACT changes needed to be identified

Discovery research of 14 interviews, a survey, and a quant report of 375 mill. users provided critical data I used to identify what mattered most to users.



## Roster as meeting “home”

- ✦ Lacks clear active speaker cue
- ✦ Lacks virtual presence (e.g. pics)

LOW COST

HIGH COST

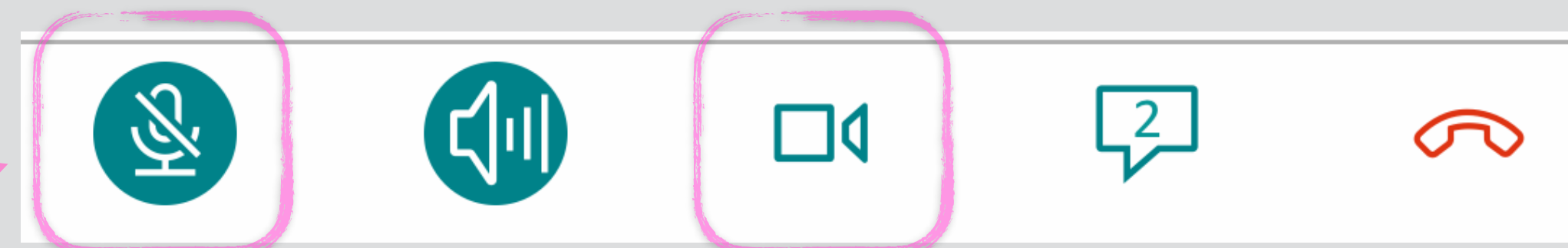


## Clear architecture & controls—

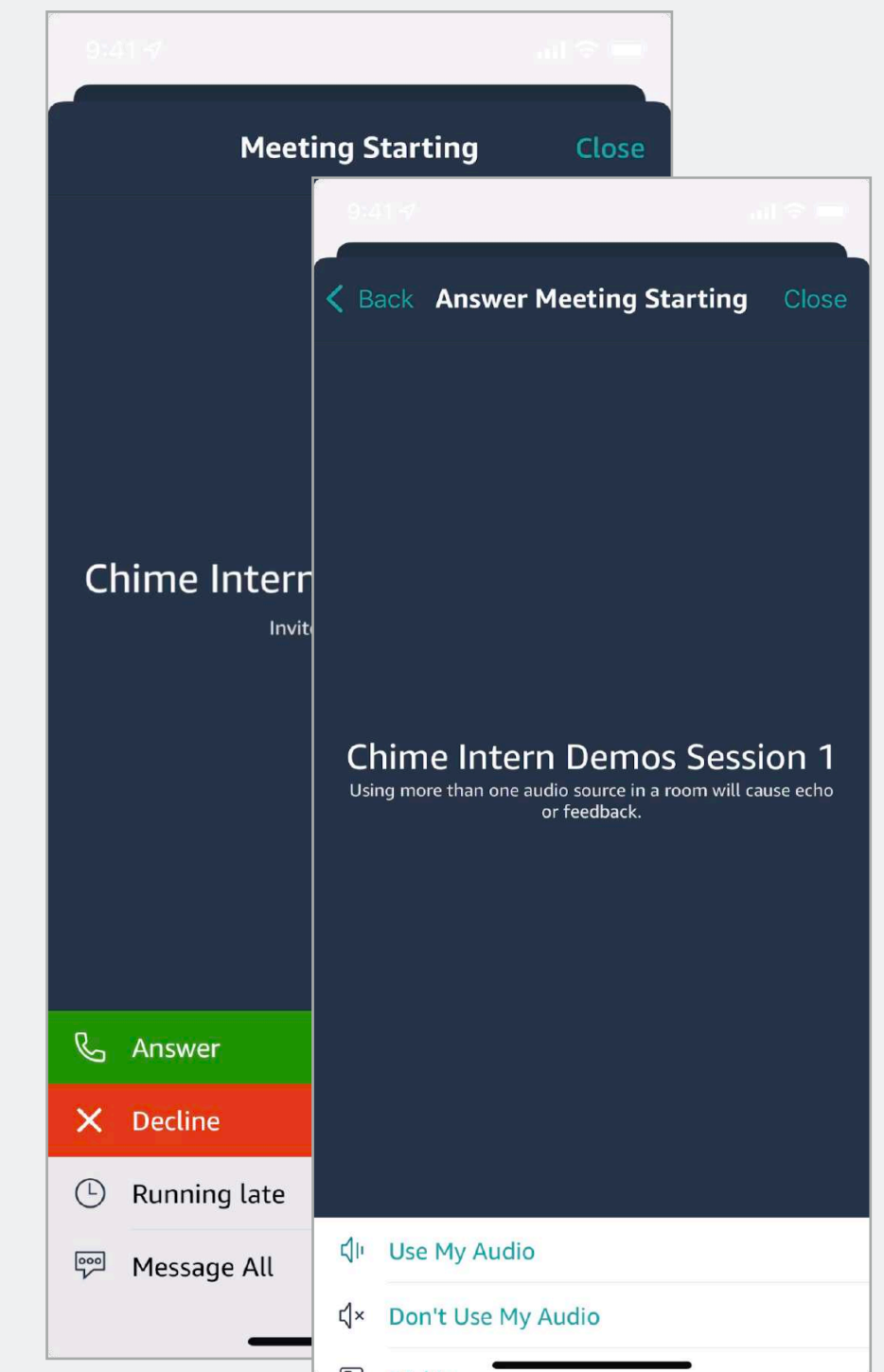
Source of most logged user complaints

- ✦ Unclear mic & camera status
- ✦ Lots of accidentally leaving meeting
- ✦ No “raise hand” feature
- ✦ Options unstructured & unintuitive

MED-HIGH COST



Guess your mic & camera status...



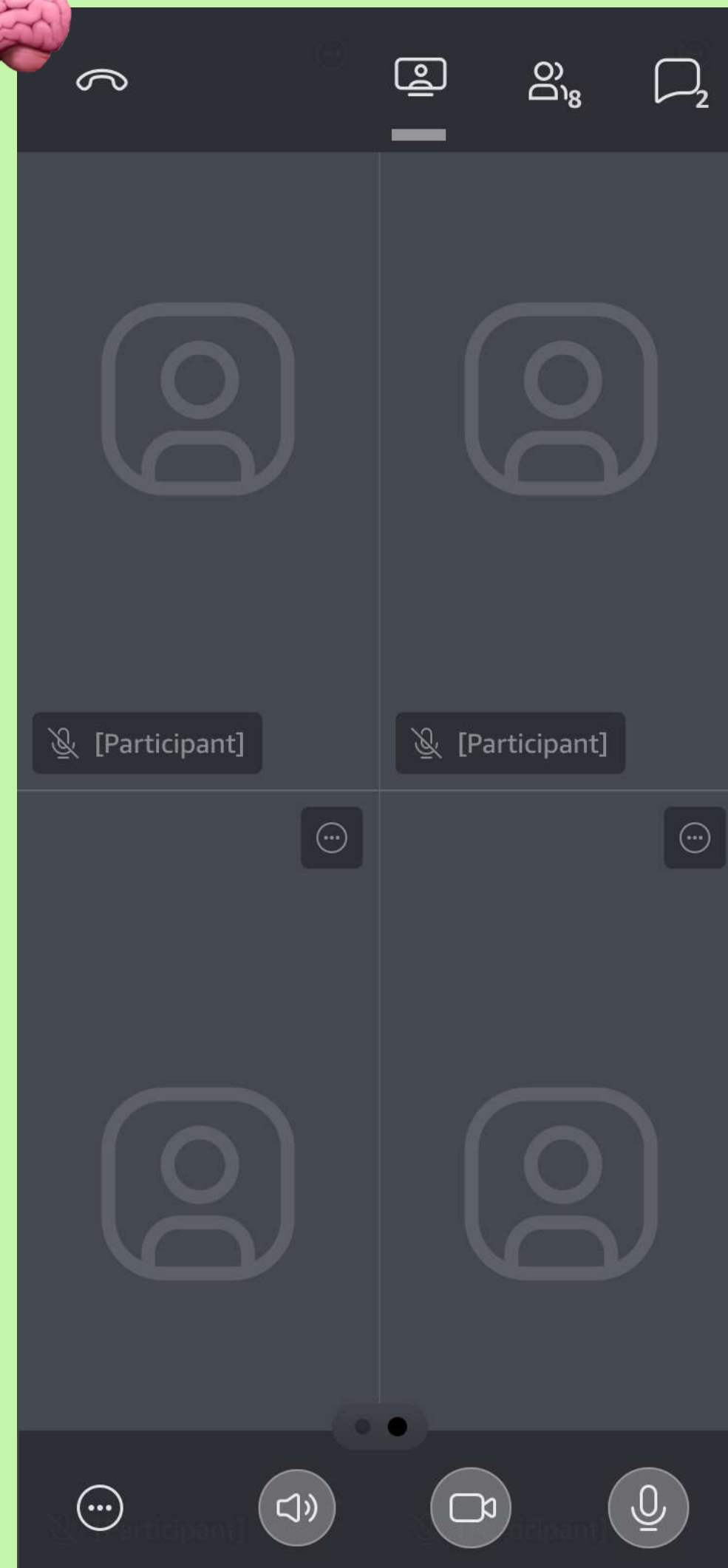
## Reduced join friction—

currently 2 steps, more difficult while on the move

MED-LOW COST

## Early testing corrected big assumptions

Usability of 10 participants with 2 clickable prototypes and card sort quickly settled disagreements over big decisions.

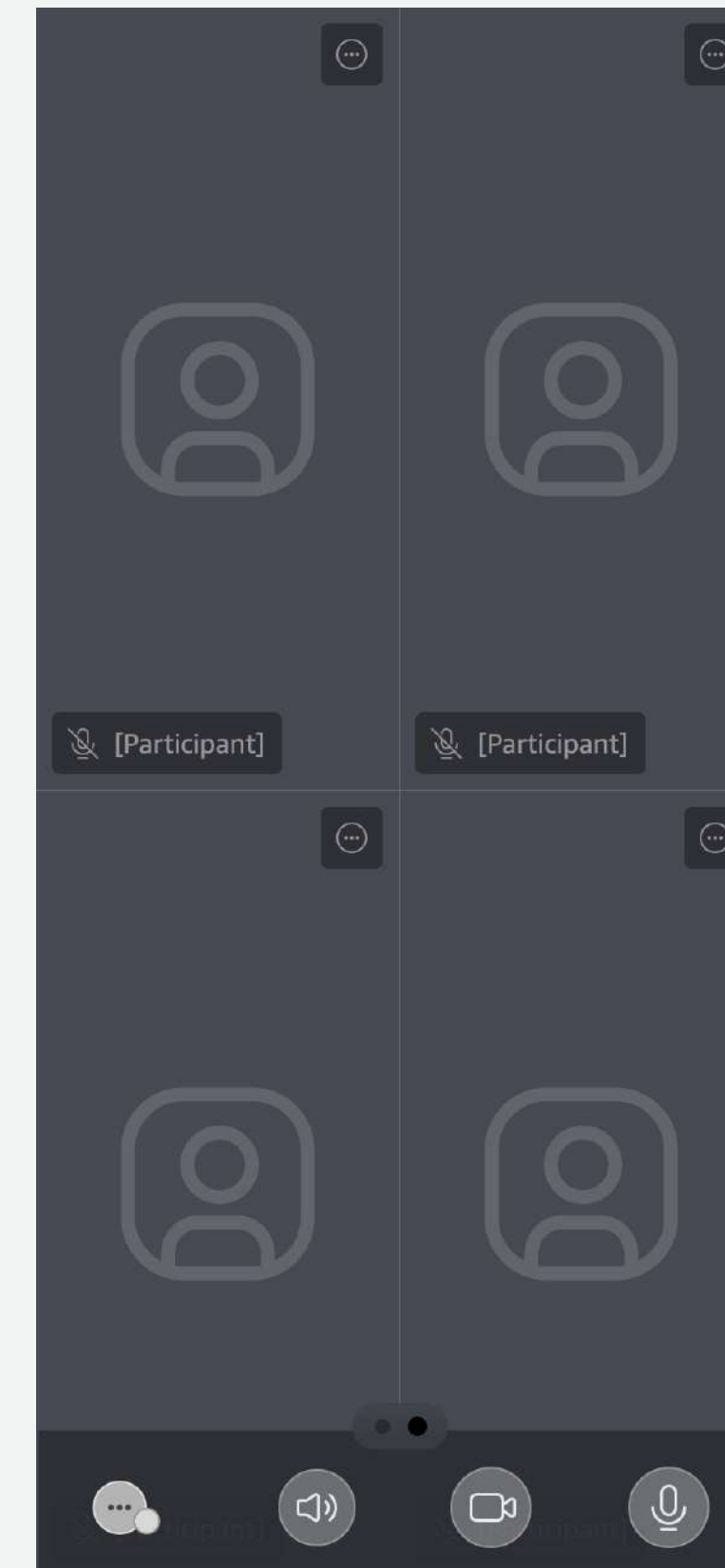


### Var A - Classic

- Preferred quick access to roster & chat
- Addition of count in roster & chat was highly appreciated
- Most were thrilled the end call button was “out of the way”

### Bonus validation

- Almost all participants didn't want to start on video—they sought the list of attendees first



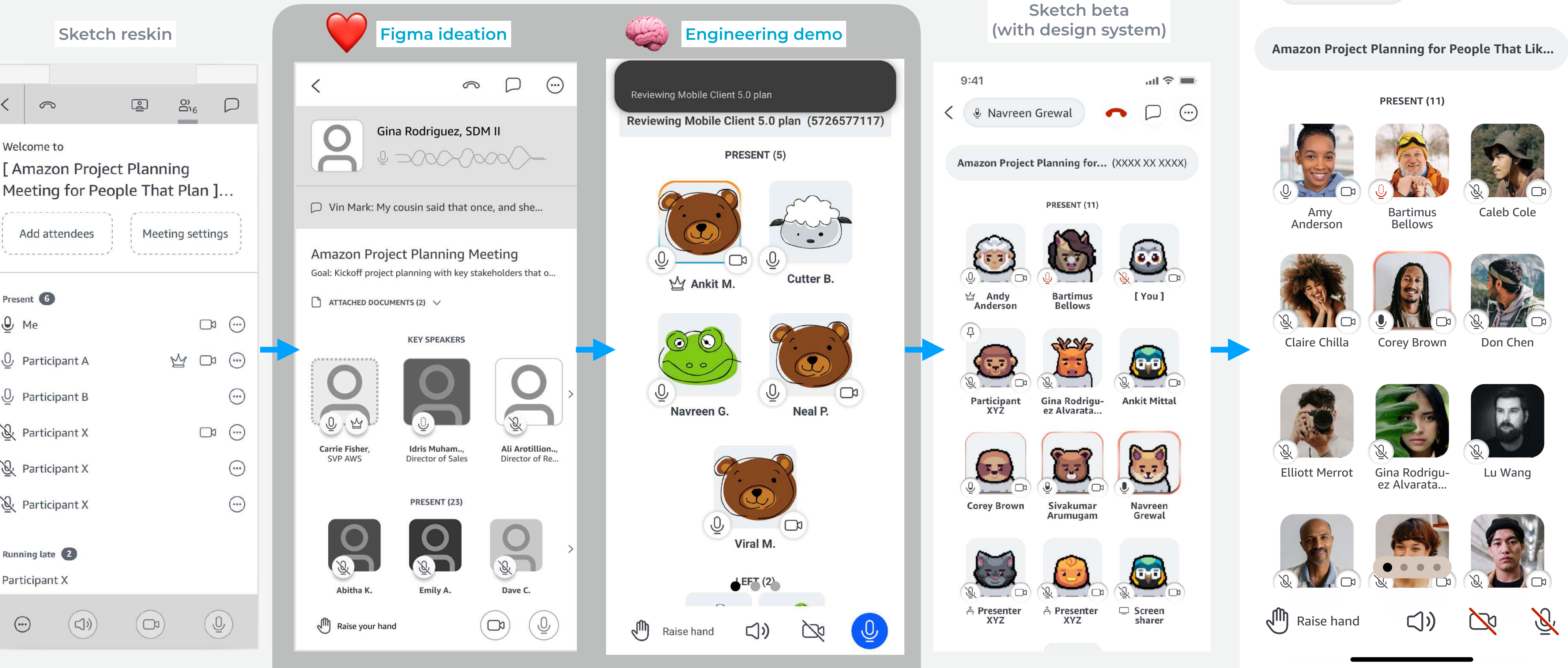
### Var B - Thumb optimized

- Many were uneasy without access to roster
- Many quickly understood anything missing is in ellipses button



# Roster had the boldest overhaul

This best reflects the app’s overall evolution. Engineering was understandably nervous about large-effort changes. Along with usability data and feasibility talks, they became comfortable pushing the envelope by building a demo in tandem with design.



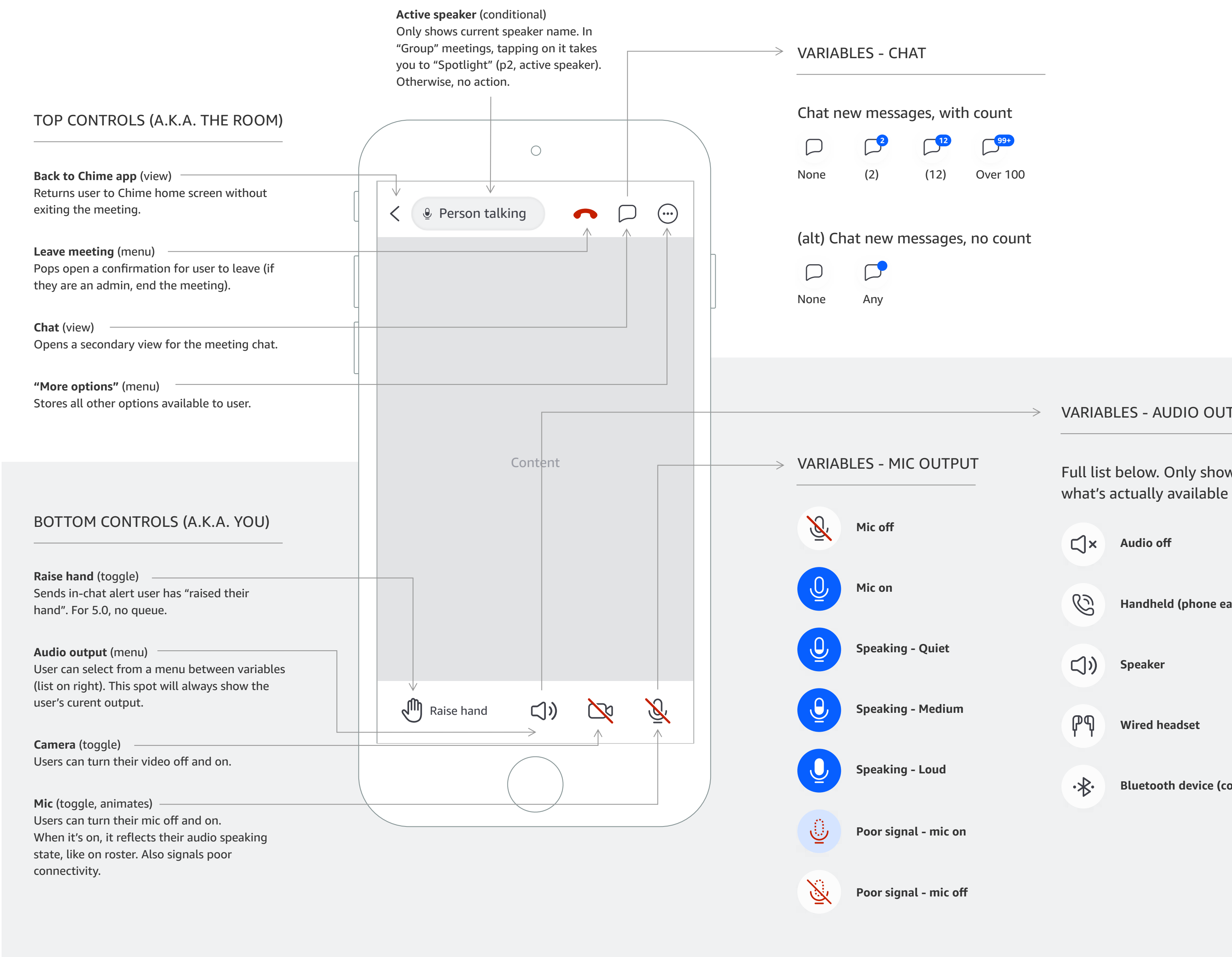


MAKE IT SO

Design spec handoff

Engineering and I volleyed this way until launch. The redesign was so broad in the end that I created a finalized UX “spec” for these benefits:

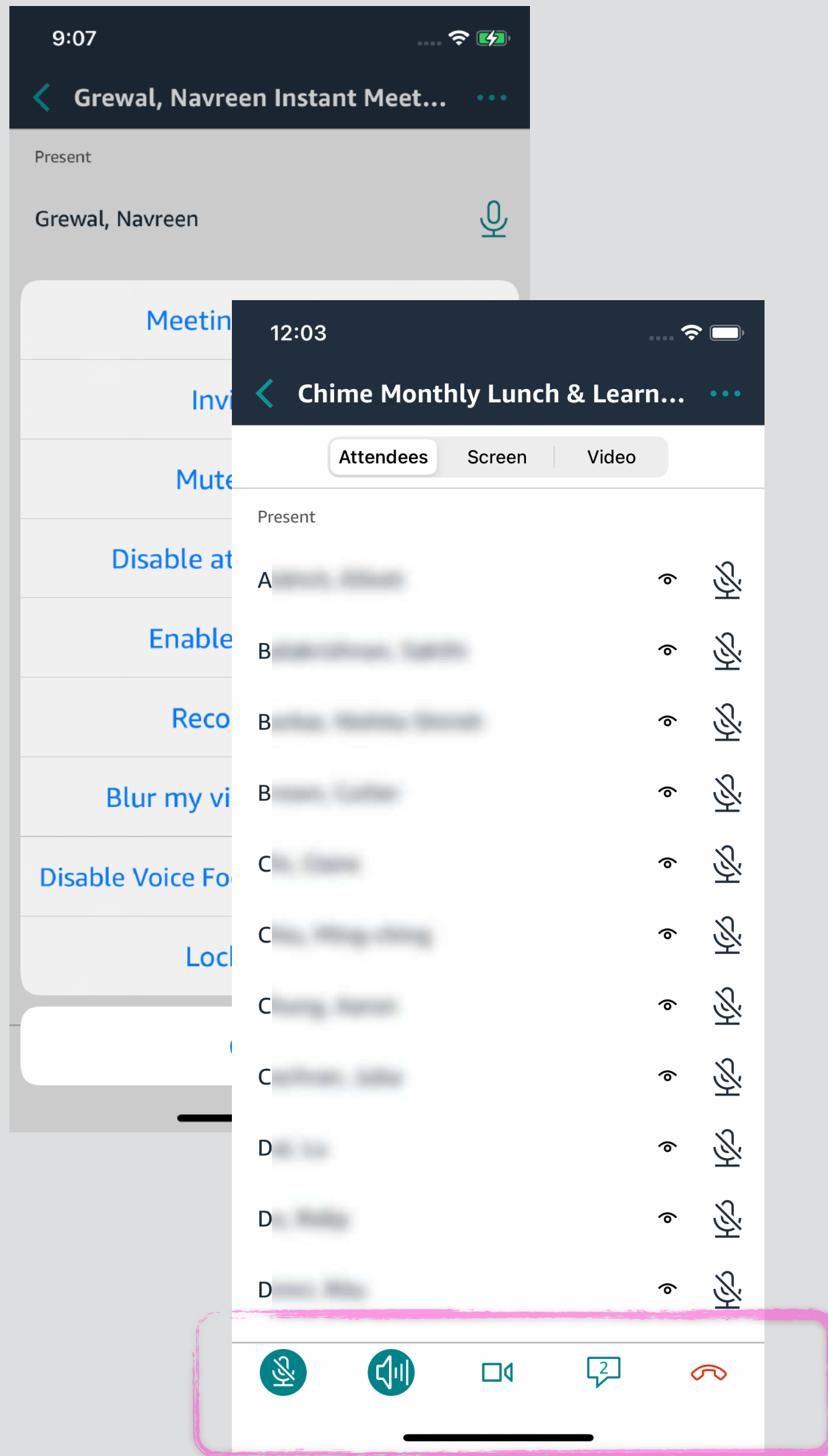
- ◆ Capture what we defined collaboratively—architecture, interactions, and design system
- ◆ Close gaps between product decisions, engineering interpretation, and documentation
- ◆ Reduce misunderstandings, reassuring newcomers that a methodical approach was taken



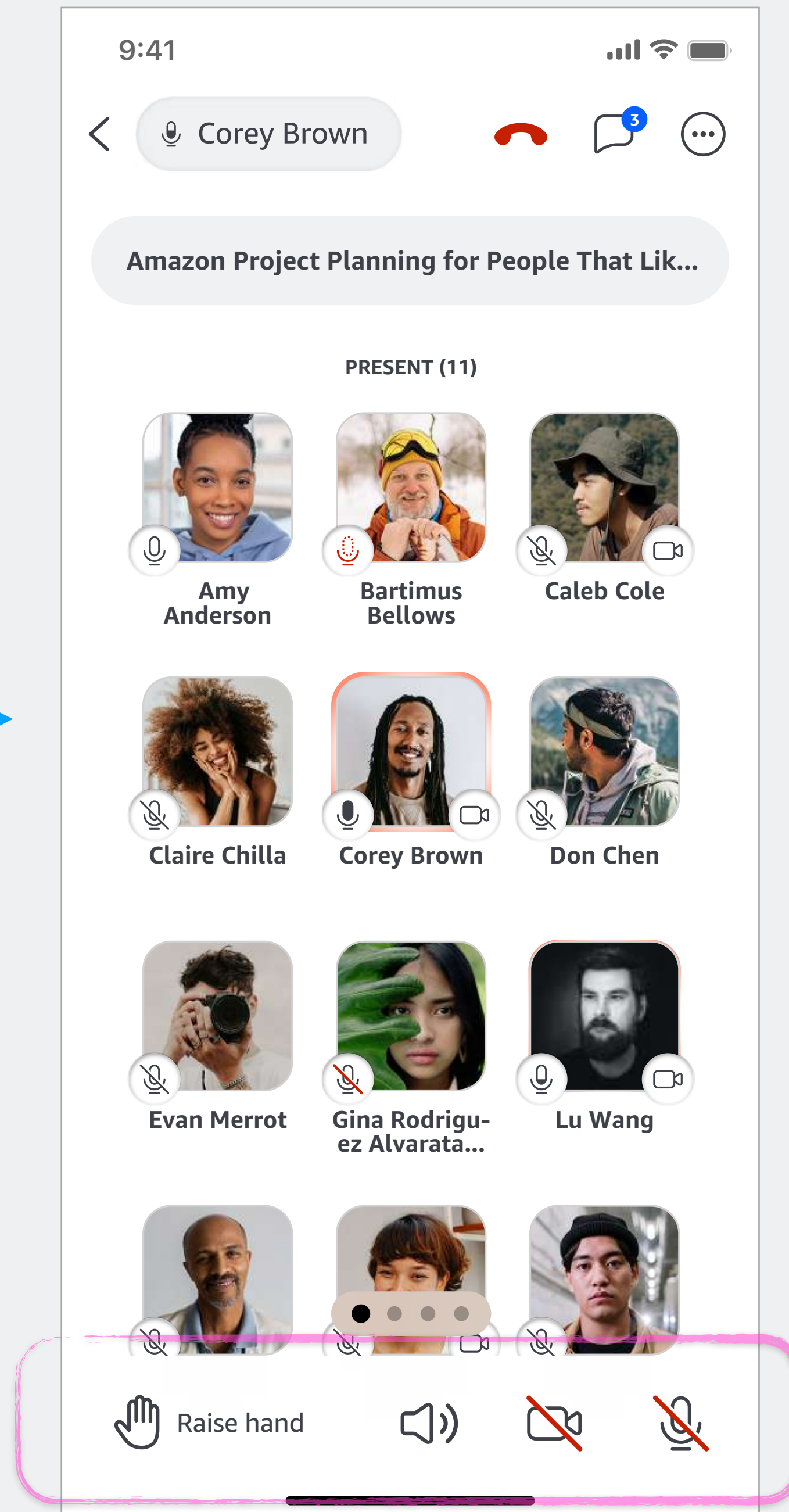


YOU'LL BE SO TIRED OF WINNING

**5.0's  &  redesign**



4.39 Roster & Menu  
(muted + speaker)



5.0

## THE AFTER

### Meeting room (roster/attendees)

- Persistent and clear “active speaker” cues
- Virtual presence with photos

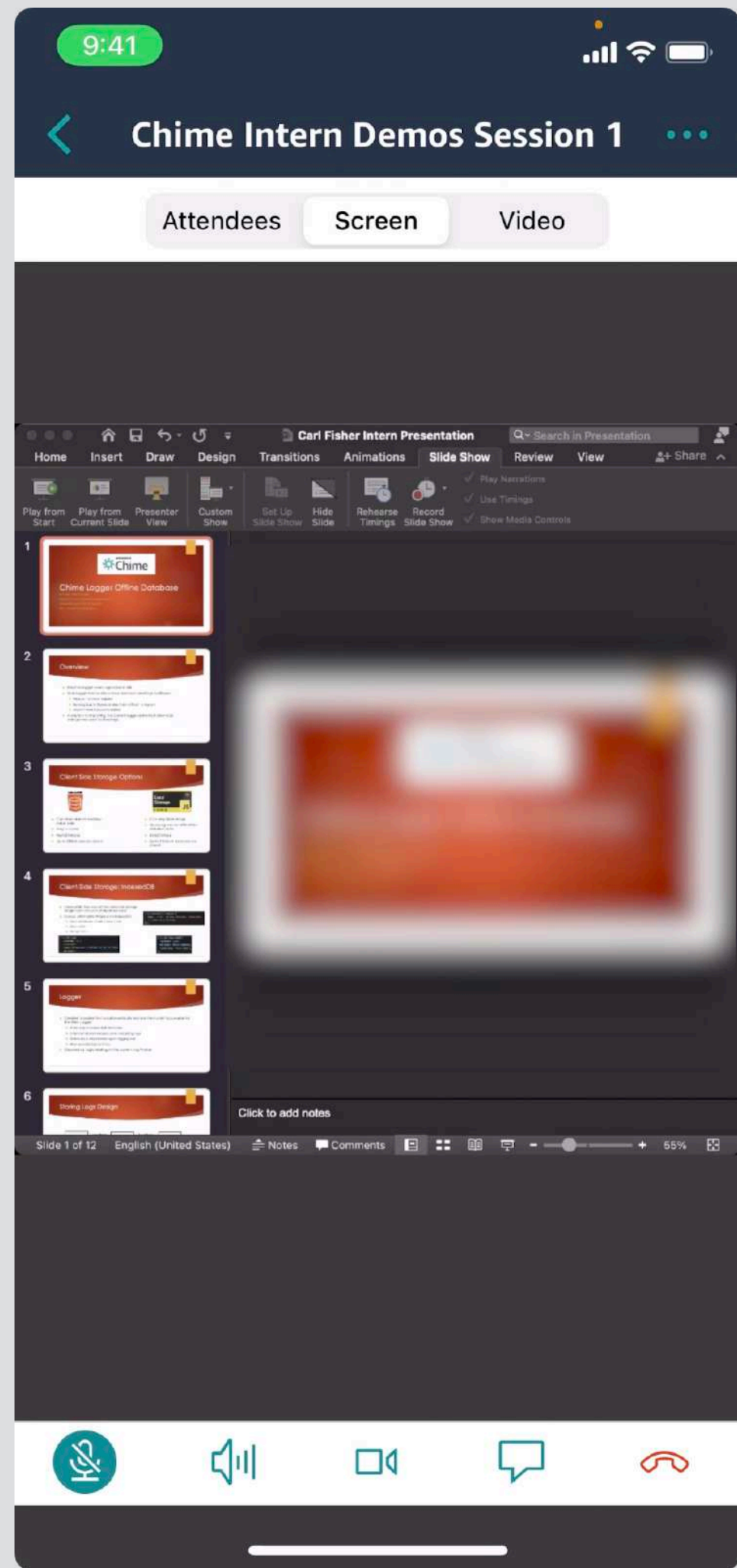
### Meeting controls

- Clear video/ audio toggle states
- Move infrequently used options away from thumb

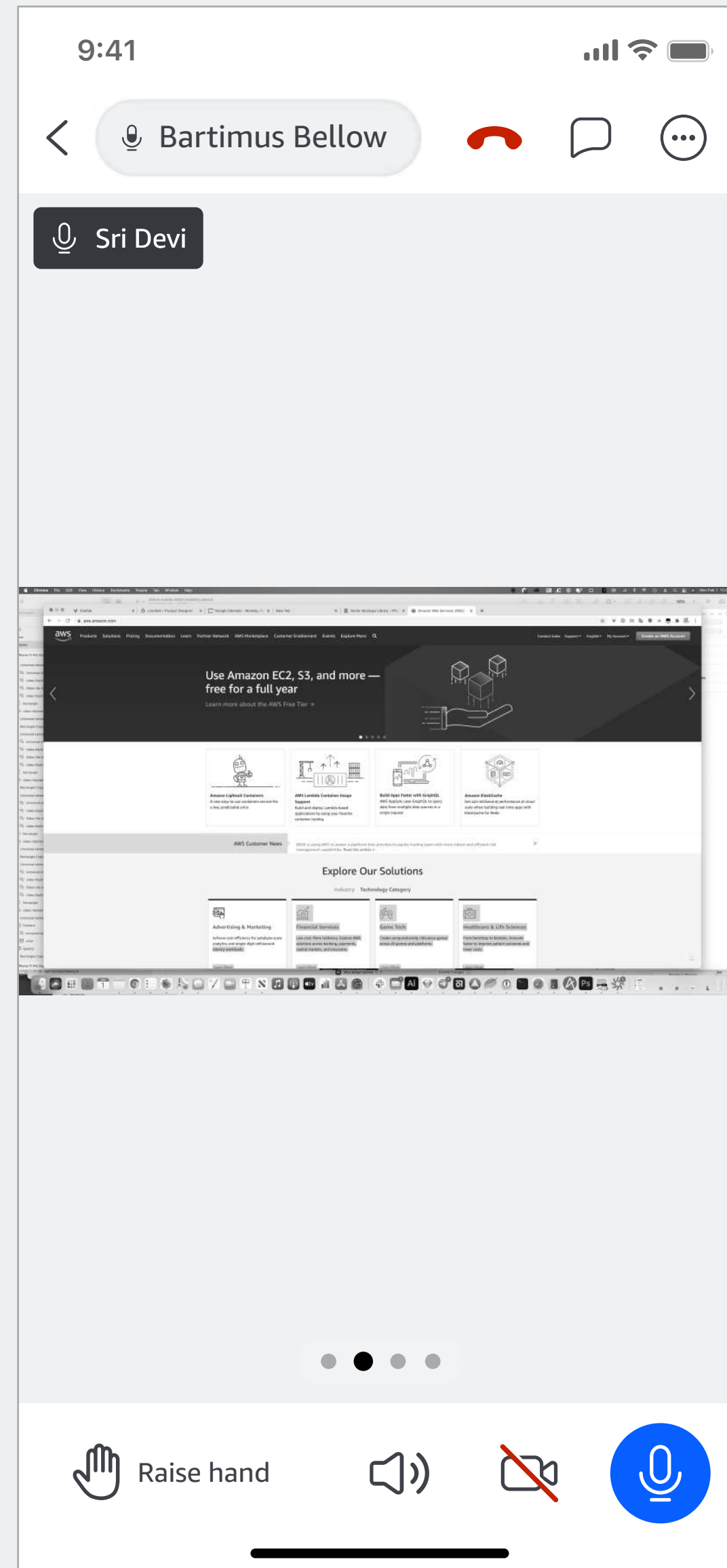
### Menus & alerts

- Restructure options and alerts across platforms, utilizing native patterns
- Reduce cross-platform discrepancies





4.39



5.0 (Screenshare, active speaker video)

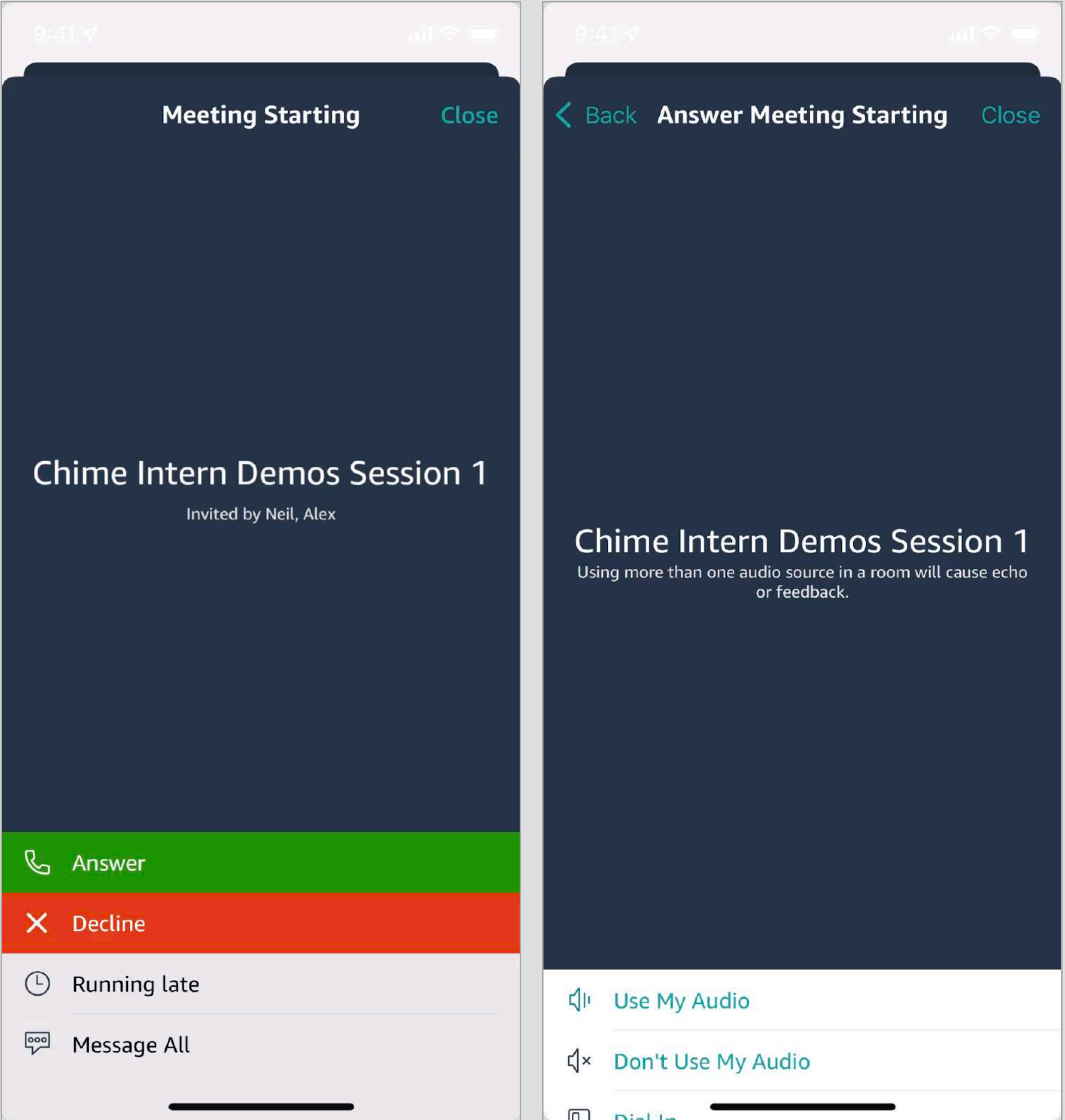


THE AFTER

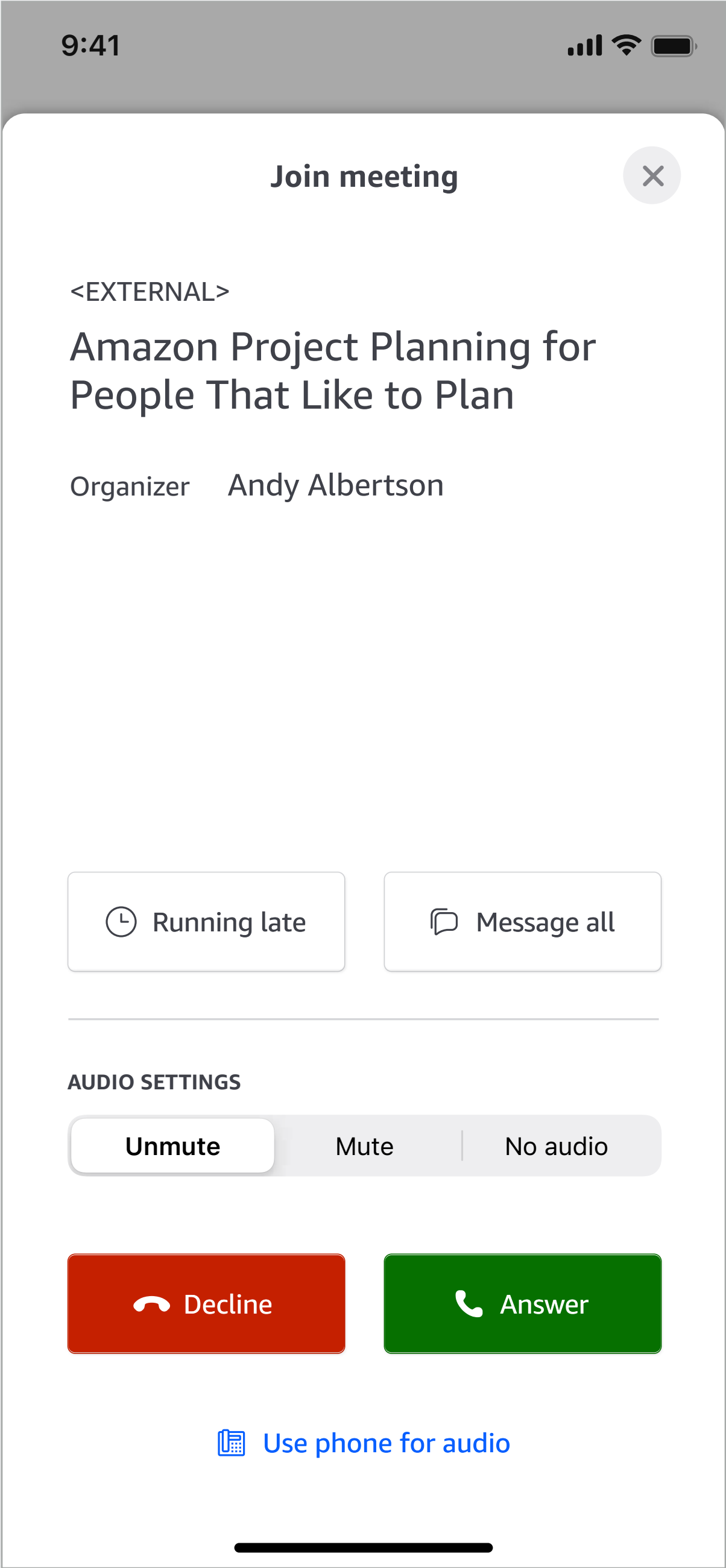
## Spotlight

- Adaptive “Spotlight” shows meeting focal point (screen share → active speaker → pinned video)
- Expanded screenshare interactions—zoom, pan, horizontal orientation





4.39



5.0

## THE AFTER

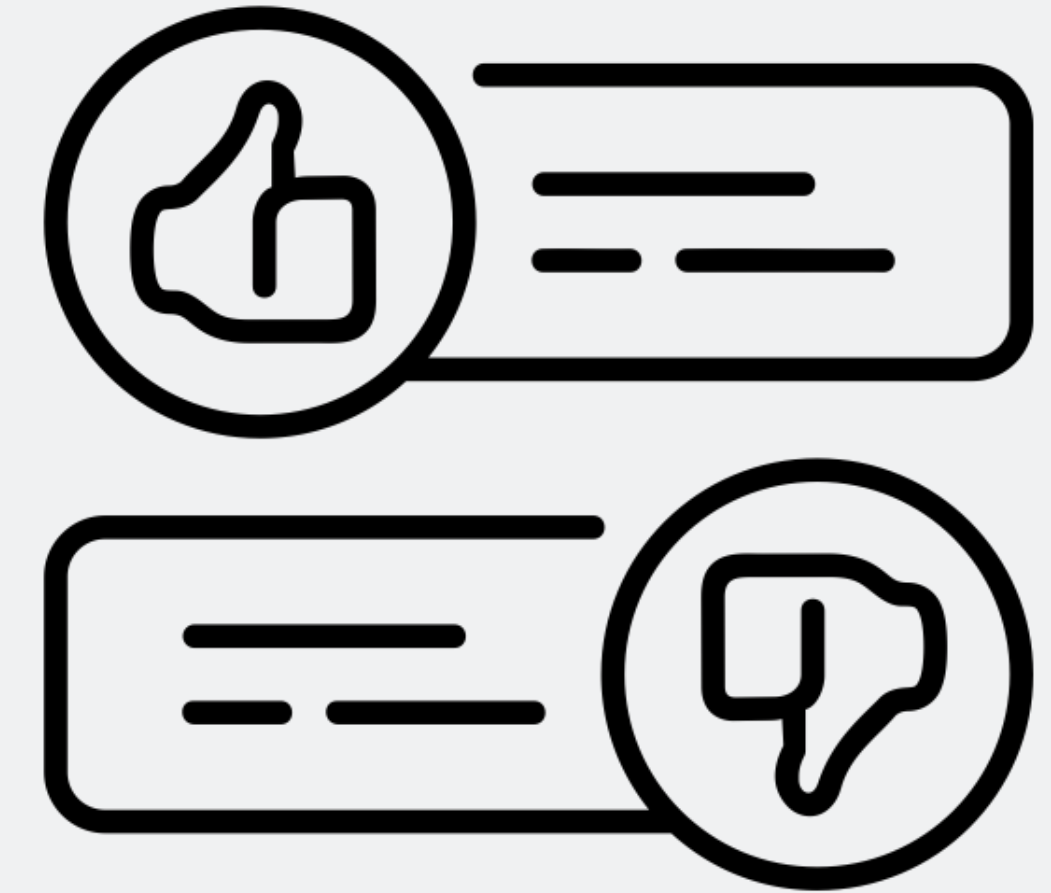
### Join meeting

- Consolidate “join meeting” steps
- Simplify audio settings while adding new options—join muted or unmuted
- Save last used audio setting
- Prioritize options according to data and usability



## Feedback from beta users

Several usability sessions in beta and 3 in-depth surveys of over 400 participants showed an **86% average satisfaction** rating from a very tough Amazonian crowd. Most negative feedback were around the animal placeholders and lack of dark mode, which would be fixed in the final launch.

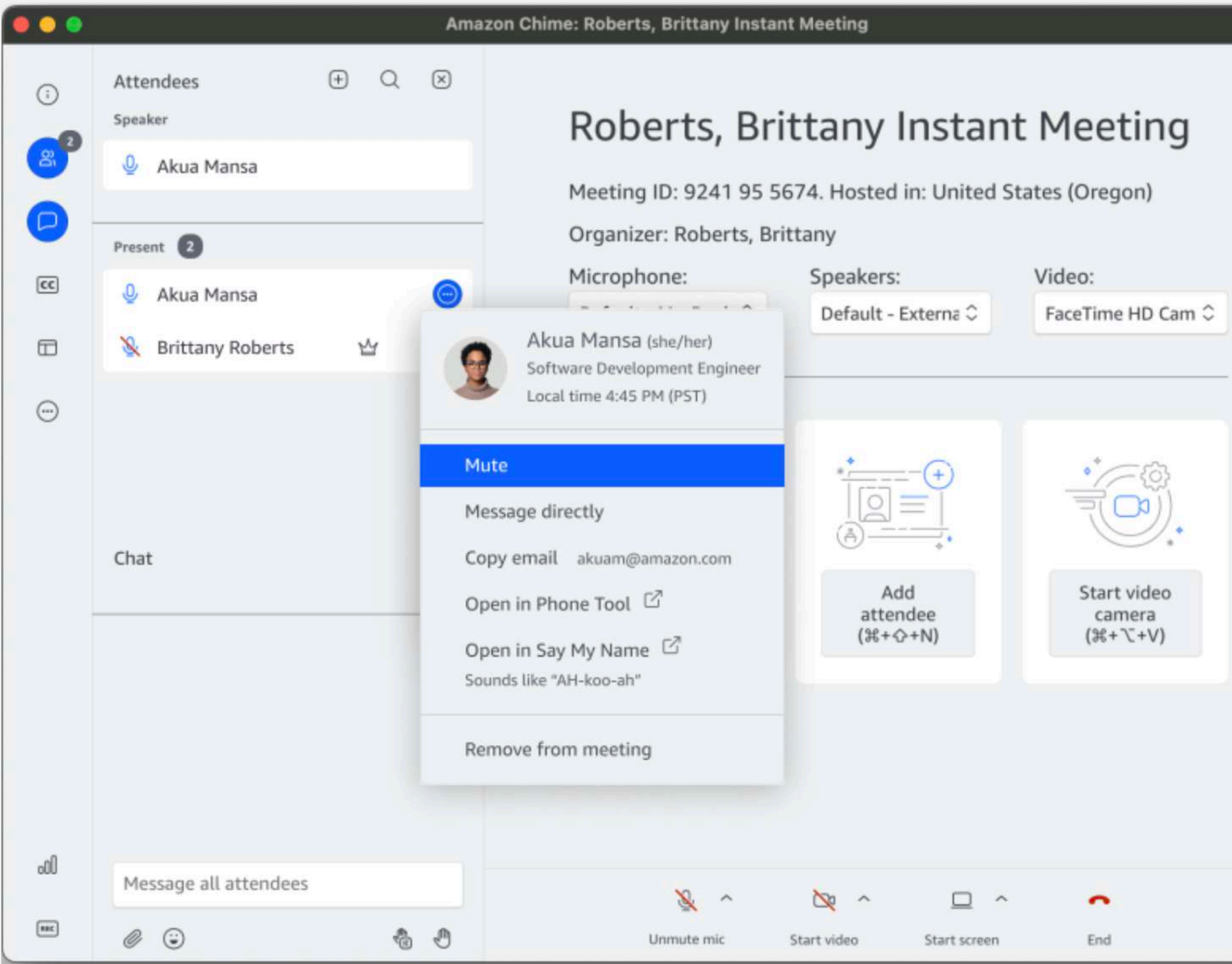
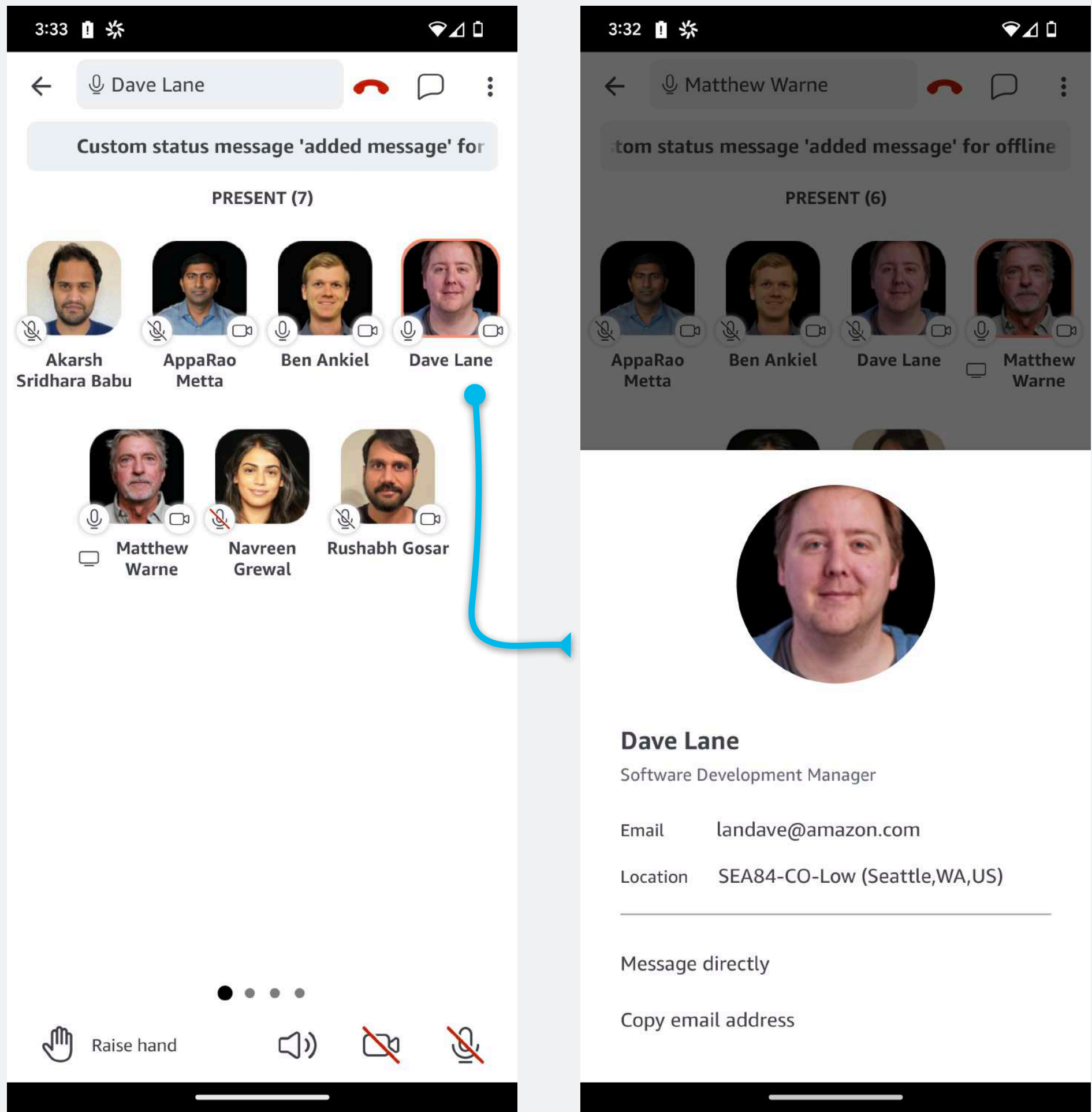


- + “I like the new user interface. it looks cleaner, and i had an easier time finding the controls.”
- + “While driving easy to listen not miss any info was my super power.”
- + “I like the first page with all the participants and that i can use the raise hand functionality”
- + “I love the animals! it adds some fun character and a little bit of the goofyness of amazon that's missing so much these days.”

- “I strongly dislike the animal icons...actual pictures of people would be more helpful.”
- “All this white is so bright when I’m using this at night when is dark mode coming?!”

# Profile pics were worth the cost to build

This feature was considered costly and got a lot of pushback, but user data showed it was strongly desired. After launch, it received such positive feedback that it catalyzed our desktop team into figuring out integration. It also lead to deeper profile view across platforms.





## ROOM FOR IMPROVEMENT

### Launch & learn

The redesign reduced complaints about common meeting issues. User requests shifted focus to feature ideas and improvements:

- ✦ Roster needed continued refinement—previews of meeting chat messages, indications of screen share in progress, and a grid/list view
- ✦ Mobile users desired a more prominent mic, and left-handed users complained of the button being too far out of reach.
- ✦ Driving mode was a known demand but had to be descope from 5.0. It had to be a high priority follow-up on the roadmap.
- ✦ Profile pics lead to demand for customization

5.X follow-up

